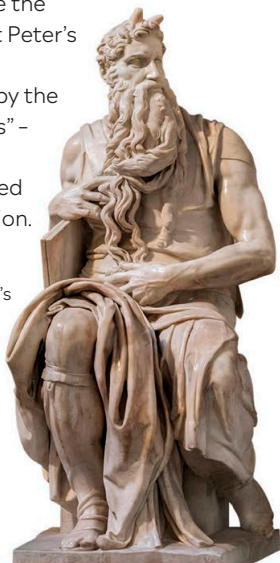


1503

RENAISSANCE POPE

Julius II, pope from 1503 to 1509, was a worldly man who personally led papal troops in battle. He employed major Renaissance artists such as Raphael and Michelangelo to decorate the Vatican and plan a new St Peter's Basilica. His lavish artistic patronage was financed by the mass sale of "indulgences" – remission of sins. Such corrupt practices provoked the Protestant Reformation.

▷ **Moses**, from Michelangelo's Tomb of Pope Julius II

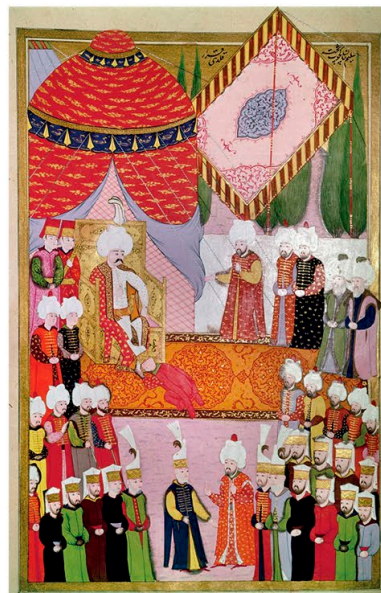


1500

1517 CAIRO FALLS TO THE OTTOMANS

Reigning from 1512 to 1520, Sultan Selim I almost doubled the extent of the Ottoman Empire. His conquest of Cairo in 1517 ended Mamluk rule over Egypt and Syria, giving the Ottomans control of the heartland of the Muslim world, including the holy cities of Mecca and Medina. This allowed Selim to claim the title of caliph, leader of Islam.

Selim blocked the spread of Shi'ism, massacring Shi'ites and fighting Safavid Iran.



△ The coronation of Sultan Selim I

1513 At the Battle of Flodden, King James IV of Scotland is killed fighting the English

1510 The Portuguese establish a permanent base in India at Goa

1517 Portuguese merchants reach the Chinese port of Canton by sea



1501

FOUNDING OF SAFAVID IRAN

The Safavids were Sufi Muslim mystics adhering to the Shi'ite branch of Islam. In 1501, Safavid Shah Ismail I claimed rulership of politically fragmented Iran, establishing his control over a wide area in campaigns that culminated in the defeat of the Uzbeks at Merv in 1510. Ismail's Shi'ite Safavid Empire posed a direct challenge to the Sunni Ottoman Empire for leadership of Islam.

◁ **Battle at Merv**, fresco in Isfahan